



User Profile: *Newcomer Trade Worker*

Name: Joyce Wong

Age: 33

Gender: Female

Location: Richmond, BC

Work: Apprentice Plumber

Education: High School Diploma, Trade Certificate (in progress)

Marital Status: Married, with one child

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Personal Bio

Joyce moved from Taiwan to Canada two years ago. Back home, she gained experience in plumbing through hands-on apprenticeships. Since relocating, she has been working as an apprentice plumber while preparing for Canadian trade certification exams. While technically skilled, she struggles with English, especially trade-specific terminology, pronunciation, and safety instructions. Joyce wants a tool that can help her quickly learn and recall technical vocabulary, understand pronunciation, and practice communicating with supervisors and clients. She values straightforward, practical learning without overwhelming lessons. She wants to feel confident at job sites and eventually grow into a full journeyman role.

Main Point

- Wants to bridge language barriers to succeed in her trade.
- Needs clear, simple, and job-specific lessons.
- Seeks confidence in speaking with supervisors, coworkers, and customers.
- Prefers practical vocabulary over academic English.
- Values an easy-to-use mobile app she can learn from during short breaks or commutes.

Must Haves

- Simple lessons broken into short, practical modules.
- Audio features for listening and speaking practice.
- Visual aids for tools, parts, and safety equipment.
- Progress tracking with levels or gamification.
- Bilingual glossary (English–Chinese for Joyce, but adaptable to other languages).

Key Behaviors

- Studies English through YouTube and mobile apps but finds them too general or academic.
- Practices English mainly during work interactions.
- Prefers visual and audio learning over text-only content.
- Motivated to use apps that reward progress (badges, levels, quick quizzes).
- Often learns in short bursts, on the bus, during lunch, or after work.

Key Tasks /Goals

- Learn and practice trade-specific terminology (tools, safety, tasks).
- Improve pronunciation to be understood clearly at work.
- Use quick lessons or quizzes before shifts.
- Prepare for trade certification exams in English.
- Expand vocabulary across multiple trades for career mobility.

Never Do's

- Overly long lessons with too much grammar.
- Complicated navigation that wastes time.
- No offline access (he often works in areas with poor signal).
- Unclear or irrelevant vocabulary not connected to trades.

Frustrations & Pain Points

- Misunderstandings on job sites due to limited vocabulary.
- Difficulty following safety instructions in English.
- Nervousness when talking to supervisors or customers.
- Feels apps like Duolingo or Elsa Speak don't match her trade context.
- Too many ads or popups in free apps distract and discourage him.

Technology Use

- Primarily uses her mobile phone for apps and YouTube learning.
- Occasionally uses her laptop for certification exam prep.
- Prefers apps that work offline and allow short daily practice.